
AWS Trusted Advisor – Overview

What is AWS Trusted Advisor?

AWS Trusted Advisor is a **cloud optimization and best practices tool** that provides real-time recommendations to help you:

- ✓ Reduce costs
- ✓ Improve performance
- ✓ Increase security
- ✓ Enhance fault tolerance
- ✓ Service limits monitoring

Think of it as your **cloud consultant**, continuously auditing your AWS account and recommending improvements.

Trusted Advisor Checks

Trusted Advisor offers **checks** in the following categories:

Category	What It Covers
✓ Cost Optimization	Unused resources (e.g., idle EC2, underutilized EBS)
 Security	Open ports, IAM best practices, MFA on root, S3 public access
 Performance	Resource usage, instance type recommendations
 Fault Tolerance	Backup status, AZ balance, Auto Scaling health



Service Limits

Approaching resource limits (e.g., EC2, VPC, Lambda)



Example Checks

Check Description	Category	Actionable ?
Unused EC2 instances	Cost Optimization	✓ Yes
IAM access keys over 90 days old	Security	✓ Yes
S3 buckets with public read/write access	Security	✓ Yes
EBS snapshots older than 30 days	Fault Tolerance	✓ Yes
Service quota at 80% usage	Service Limits	✓ Yes



Pricing and Access

AWS Support Plan	Access to Trusted Advisor
Basic / Developer	7 core checks (free)
Business / Enterprise	All 50+ checks

Core Checks Available to All:

- Service Limits
- IAM Use

- MFA on Root Account
 - EBS Public Snapshots
 - S3 Public Access
 - RDS Public Snapshots
 - Security Groups (open ports)
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Accessing Trusted Advisor

Console:

- Go to <https://console.aws.amazon.com/trustedadvisor>

AWS CLI:

aws support describe-trusted-advisor-checks --language en

Best Practices

- Review **weekly** or set up **SNS notifications** for new issues
 - Use **CloudWatch Events** to automate responses
 - Combine with **Compute Optimizer** and **Cost Explorer** for full visibility
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Trusted Advisor vs. Related Tools

Tool	Focus Area
Trusted Advisor	Best practice checks
Compute Optimizer	Resource right-sizing
Cost Explorer	Visualize and forecast cost
AWS Config	Resource configuration tracking

Summary

Feature	Details
Purpose	Optimize AWS usage and security
Categories	Cost, Security, Performance, Fault Tolerance, Limits
Access	Core checks for all, full checks for paid support
Integrations	CloudWatch, SNS, CLI, APIs
